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CHAPTER ONE

HEIDEGGER AND THE MEDIEVAL THEOLOGICAL PARADIGM

*Everything we think is the fruit of the Middle Ages and indeed of
the Christian Middle Ages.*

CARL GUSTAV JUNG

Like a great oak tree that has colonized a grove by driving roots deep into subterranean springs not reached by lesser trees, Heidegger's *Sein und Zeit* has dominated the twentieth century by feeding off traditions that lesser philosophical works cannot access. Not only a forgotten Aristotle, but also Martin Luther, Duns Scotus, medieval mysticism, and early Christianity are connected in numerous hidden ways to this massive monument to modern angst. These roots are buried deep beneath the surface of *Sein und Zeit*'s transcendental phenomenological discourse, but they are the source of the book's strength. A central root runs through Heidegger's biography: his defection from the reactionary Catholicism of his seminary days, a protest that required him to disentangle his spiritual and intellectual life, and then philosophy itself, from the neo-Scholasticism in which he had been schooled.¹ Another root stems from medieval Aristotelian ontology. The last philosophers prior to Heidegger to ask ques-

1. On Heidegger's Catholic roots, see Alfred Denker, "Heideggers Lebens- und Denkweg 1909–1919," in *Heidegger-Jahrbuch*, ed. Alfred Denker, Hans-Helmuth Gander, and Holger Zaborowski, vol. 1, *Heidegger und die Anfänge seines Denkens* (Freiburg and Munich: Verlag Karl Alber, 2004), 97–202; Holger Zaborowski, "'Herkunft aber bleibt stets Zukunft.' Anmerkungen zur religiösen und theologischen Dimension des Denkwegs Martin Heideggers bis 1919," in *Heidegger Jahrbuch*, 1:123–58; Ott, *Biographie*; Ott, "Zu den katholischen Wurzeln"/"Heidegger's Catholic Origins."

tions about the nature of being, the distinctions between different modes of being, and the difference between the being of beings and the being of being, were the “medieval schoolmen.”² The largest root runs deep into the early Protestant objection to medieval theology, and, through Luther, into the faith of primal Christianity.³ Heidegger was as intimate with this intellectual history as if it were his very own. His internalization of these ideas lends *Sein und Zeit* a historical *gravitas* lacking in other contemporary works.

And yet *Sein und Zeit* is a Godless eschatology. It is a phenomenological analysis of what Dilthey described as “historical consciousness,” which Dilthey discovered, not in the Greeks, but in early Christiani-

2. On Heidegger and the Middle Ages, see *Quaestio. Annuario di storia della metafisica*, vol. 1, *Heidegger e i medievali. Atti del Colloquio Internazionale Cassino 10/13 maggio 2000*, ed. Costantino Esposito and Pasquale Porro (Turnhout, Belgium: Brepols, 2001). This volume contains an exhaustive bibliography of the literature on Heidegger's relationship to medieval philosophy. I have made use of *Heidegger und das Mittelalter*, ed. Helmuth Vetter (Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang, 1999); Robert Bernasconi, “On Heidegger's Other Sins of Omission: His Exclusion of Asian Thought from the Origins of Occidental Metaphysics and His Denial of the Possibility of Christian Philosophy,” *American Catholic Philosophical Quarterly* 69 (1995): 333–49; John Caputo, *Heidegger and Aquinas: An Essay on Overcoming Metaphysics* (New York: Fordham University Press, 1982); Johannes Baptist Lotz, *Martin Heidegger und Thomas von Aquin. Mensch—Zeit—Sein* (Pfullingen: Günther Neske, 1975); Thomas J. Sheehan, “Notes on a ‘Lovers’ Quarrel: Heidegger and Aquinas,” *Listening* 9 (1974): 137–43; John M. Deely, *The Tradition via Heidegger: An Essay on the Meaning of Being in the Philosophy of Martin Heidegger* (The Hague: Nijhoff, 1971).

3. On Heidegger's early religion lectures, in addition to Kisiel's *Genesis of Being and Time* and van Buren's *Young Heidegger*, see *A Companion to Heidegger's Phenomenology of Religious Life*, ed. Sean J. McGrath and Andrzej Wiercinski (forthcoming); Jean Greisch, *L'Arbre de vie et l'arbre du savoir: Le chemin phénoménologique de l'herméneutique heideggérienne (1919–1923)* (Paris: Cerf, 2000); Gerhard Ruff, *Am Ursprung der Zeit. Studie zu Martin Heideggers phänomenologischen Zugang zur christlichen Religion in den ersten “Freiburger Vorlesungen”* (Berlin: Duncker & Humblot, 1997). For a more general treatment of Heidegger's appropriation of Christianity, see Hans-Georg Gadamer, *Heidegger's Ways*, trans. John W. Stanley (Albany: State University of New York Press, 1994). On Heidegger and Luther, see Otto Pöggeler, “Heidegger's Luther-Lektüre im Freiburg Theologenkonvikt,” in Denker, Gander, and Zaborowski, *Heidegger-Jahrbuch*, 1:185–96; idem, *Martin Heidegger's Path of Thinking*, trans. David Magurshak and Sigmund Barber (Atlantic Highlands, N.J.: Humanities Press, 1987); Sean J. McGrath, “The Facticity of Being Godforsaken: The Young Heidegger's Accommodation of Luther's Theology of the Cross,” *American Catholic Philosophical Quarterly* 79 (2005): 273–90; idem, “Das verborgene theologische Anliegen von *Sein und Zeit*: Die Luther Lektüre des jungen Heidegger,” in *Phänomenologie der Religion. Zugänge und Grundfragen*, ed. Markus Enders and Holger Zaborowski (Freiburg and Munich: Verlag Karl Alber, 2004), 271–78; John van Buren, “Martin Heidegger. Martin Luther,” in Kisiel and van Buren, *Reading Heidegger from the Start*, 159–74; Richard Schaeffler, *Frömmigkeit des Denkens. Martin Heidegger und die katholische Theologie* (Darmstadt: Wissenschaftliche Buchgesellschaft, 1978), chap. 1.

ty—without God. Heidegger gives a formal interpretation of the apocalyptic sense, which he studied carefully in Paul and Luther. On the basis of this theological research, he constructs an apocalypse without end. The theological content of the New Testament is suspended, placed into phenomenological brackets. This becomes all the more clear when one compares the *Daseinanalytic* with Heidegger's 1920/21 lectures on Paul. For both Paul and Heidegger, the life that is self-understood as a "being-unto-an-end" is essentially historical. Paul's end is Christ, that for the sake of which the heavens and the earth have been created. Heidegger's end is death, Dasein's possibility of its own impossibility. What does it mean to be thrown toward an end that is not a *telos*? Robert Bernasconi also wonders about this. He asks: "The question is whether by confining the analysis of death to the 'this-worldly,' Heidegger had not implicitly made a decision against the 'other-worldly' and truncated the phenomenon at issue."⁴

At an early stage in his career, Heidegger appears to have allowed his enthusiasm for radical Protestantism to determine the phenomenological outcome of his questioning. To be sure, this argument, although not popular among Heideggerians, is not new. What is new is the full textual evidence necessary to confirm it. John Macquarrie once asked whether Heidegger's commitment to Barthian theology infected the purity of his phenomenology.⁵ We can answer yes, with the proviso that it was not Barth as such, but Luther who won Heidegger's allegiance, perhaps as early as 1909, although it would not be until his Marburg years that he could set free the budding Protestant within him. Max Scheler was suspicious of the theological sources informing *Sein und Zeit* already in 1927, when he carefully worked his way through the copy Heidegger himself had sent him. "Thrownness," "fallenness," "being-unto-death," the futile call of "conscience," which only serves to remind Dasein of its finitude—these notions struck Scheler as neo-Calvinist tropes imported into phenomenology without phenomenological justification.⁶ In paragraph 62

4. Robert Bernasconi, "Whose Death is it anyway? Philosophy and the Cultures of Death," in *Acta Institutionis Philosophiae et Aestheticae*, vol. 15, ed. Tomonou Imamichi (Tokyo, 1997), 13–25.

5. John Macquarrie, *Heidegger and Christianity* (New York: Continuum, 1994), 55.

6. Max Scheler, *Gesammelte Werke*, vol. 9, *Späte Schriften*, ed. Manfred Frings (Bern: Francke,

of *Sein und Zeit*, Heidegger admits that “a definite ontic interpretation of authentic existence, a factual ideal of Dasein,” underlies his ontology (SZ 310/286). Scheler’s suspicion is that this ontic conception is nothing other than radical-Protestant anthropology.

The thesis of this book is that Heidegger arrived at the Godless eschatology of *Sein und Zeit*, which will issue in the later critique of “onto-theology,” through a systematic, if covert, overthrowing of the medieval theological paradigm, which has come to be known as “Scholasticism.” Considering the great diversity of philosophical and theological positions in the Middle Ages, there is some question whether there is any sense in speaking of Scholasticism as a unity. Used as a derogatory category for dismissing the philosophy and theology of the Middle Ages (a period lasting a thousand years), the term “Scholasticism” covers a range of diverse philosophical positions that encompass the full spectrum of premodern Western philosophy: from strict rationalism, to direct realism, to proto-idealism and uncompromising nominalism. How can philosophers as polemically related as Anselm and Aquinas, Scotus and Ockham, be legitimately included in the same category? As Philipp Rosemann asks in his *Understanding Scholastic Thought with Foucault*, “What (if anything) characterizes and distinguishes medieval intellectual culture, beyond the mere historical fact that it took place during the period we call the ‘Middle Ages?’”⁷ A traditional answer to this question finds a unity in a “doctrinal body,” the successful fusion of Christian and Greek thinking, which reaches its apogee in Thomas Aquinas.⁸ However, as Rosemann notes, if the fusion of Christianity with Greek philosophy is the distinguishing feature of Scholastic philosophy then we would need to include Descartes and Hegel among the Scholastics. Rosemann finds the unity of Scholastic thought, not in any particular Scholastic doctrine, but in the form of Scholastic thinking, the way the Scholastics approach every subject matter. He describes the Scholastic way as a discursive and

1976), 295, 260. See Daniel Dahlstrom, “Scheler’s Critique of Heidegger’s Fundamental Ontology,” in *Max Scheler’s Acting Persons: New Perspectives*, ed. Stephen Schneck (Amsterdam: Rodopi, 2002), 67–92. A translation of some of Scheler’s notes appeared as Max Scheler, “Reality and Resistance: On *Being and Time*, Section 43,” trans. Thomas J. Sheehan, *Listening* 12 (1977): 61–73.

7. Philipp Rosemann, *Understanding Scholastic Thought with Foucault* (New York: St. Martin’s Press, 1999), 45.

8. *Ibid.*, 46.

dialectical balancing of authority (*auctoritas*), principally the authority of theology with its roots in a divine revelation, and natural reason (*ratio*).⁹ Scholasticism never regards finite reason as a final court of appeal. “In the Scholastic *episteme*, the confidence in the powers of human reason to discover the texture of the real is counterbalanced by the insight that God, ultimately, transcends the text—every text.”¹⁰

Rosemann’s interpretation of Scholasticism closely parallels my own. It serves to highlight exactly what Heidegger objects to in medieval philosophy: not the notion of revelation as such, but the assumption that revelation and a philosophical approach to God could be complementary. Every philosophy that can be termed “Scholastic” ventures a precarious high-wire act, balancing the primacy of a revealed theology and the freedom of philosophy. The Scholastics sought a theology that balanced the sovereignty of a supernatural revelation and the dignity of science; the finitude of reason—revealed in the revelation itself—and the possibility of a basic philosophical knowledge of God. The primacy of theology, the sovereignty of revelation, the finitude of reason—these are modifications of the Scholastic belief in the *fact* of a divine disclosure of supernatural truth. The freedom of philosophy, the dignity of science, the possibility of philosophical theology, all refer to the equally central Scholastic conviction that human reason is capable of a measure of truth. Revelation did not annul what reason had been able to establish “on its own,” but confirmed, complemented, and empowered it. Even William of Ockham retains the Scholastic conviction that God can be grasped to some degree through a philosophical reflection of creation.¹¹ “Scholasticism,” then, designates a spectrum of medieval philosophical and theological schools sharing a belief in revelation and simultaneously, a belief in the basic power of human reason to understand something of itself, its world, and God. It follows that Luther’s declaration that reason is so disfigured by sin, it is incapable of seeking the truth without the guidance of revelation, was the ultimate anti-Scholastic bombast. As an unequivocal No to human philosophy and

9. Ibid., 47.

10. Ibid., 101.

11. Ockham holds that “adequate reasons” (but not *per se* demonstrations) can be found for God’s existence. See Armand Maurer, *The Philosophy of William of Ockham in the Light of Its Principles* (Toronto: Pontifical Institute of Mediaeval Studies, 1999), 159–83.

religion, it has been revitalized by Barth's dialectical theology and its contemporary American version, "post-liberal theology" (the "theology of crisis" paradoxically reduced to a formula). The Reformation brought the age of Scholasticism to an end. After Luther, Scholasticism lived on within Catholic circles, but its preeminence in the secular university was greatly diminished if not obliterated.

Husserl required a suspension of any God-talk that could not be verified in phenomenological intuition.¹² Heidegger to some degree remains a Husserlian on this question; philosophy does not believe (BZ 1). However, Heidegger goes further than denying philosophy recourse to a revelation. Early on in his career, as Husserl's "phenomenologist of religion," he concluded that God is not *given* to philosophy in any way. Philosophy is factually Godless.¹³ This is not to say that a discourse about God, drawing on supra-philosophical sources, and recognizing an alternative seat of authority, is not possible. A revealed theology has every right to contest philosophy's claim to ultimacy. It will, however, for this reason, remain philosophy's "mortal enemy" (GA9 66/53).

According to Merold Westphal, Heidegger is not interested in denying the existence of God, but rather in preserving the alterity of God.¹⁴ Heidegger has left open a space for a certain kind of experience of God, to be sure, but this space has been cleared by closing down other philosophical ways of thinking about God, including the Thomistic way. There is no passage in Heidegger from a reflection on the being of the human being, or the being of creation, to the being of God. Heidegger abolishes the *analogia entis*, along with the doctrine of creation itself: "That beings must be understood as created by God is adhered to as an unshakable conviction [in Scholasticism]. By this ontical declaration a putting of the ontological question is condemned from the start to impossibility" (GA24 140/100). These denials go beyond Westphal's minimalist reading

12. See Edmund Husserl, *Ideen zu einer reinen Phänomenologie und phänomenologischen Philosophie*, vol. 1, *Allgemeine Einführung in die reine Phänomenologie*, ed. Walter Biemel, *Husserliana*, vol. 3 (The Hague: Nijhoff, 1950, 1976), §58; English: *Ideas Pertaining to a Pure Phenomenology and to a Phenomenological Philosophy*, vol. 1, *General Introduction to a Pure Phenomenology*, trans. F. Kersten (The Hague: Nijhof, 1982).

13. GA61 196–97/147. See also PIA 246/193–94 n. 9; BZ 1.

14. Westphal, *Overcoming Onto-theology*, 243.

of the critique of onto-theology as an effort to preserve the alterity of God. The *analogia entis* does not lead to the onto-theology of Descartes and Hegel (Heidegger's real enemy). On the contrary, most Thomists will argue that it is precisely the forgetting of the *analogia entis* that has generated these onto-theologies.

The original motive of the early Heidegger's theological silence becomes clear through a close reading of Heidegger's earliest lectures and writings. He does not want to preserve a philosophy of religion but to show that none is possible. In 1922, Heidegger asks "Could it be that the very idea of a philosophy of religion, and especially if it does not take into account the facticity of human being, is pure nonsense?" (PIA 246/193–94 n. 9). Westphal convincingly argues that onto-theology concerns the *how*, not the *what*, of theology.¹⁵ When the affirmation of God as First Cause is motivated by calculative thinking and advanced as the first step in a totalizing reduction of being to reason, it is clearly onto-theological. On the other hand, when the affirmation of God remains with the biblical revelation and does not endeavor to translate it into the language of metaphysics, it does not fall within the purview of the critique.¹⁶ However, between the totalizing onto-theological thinking of the modern system builders and the theology of the Reformation there is the philosophical theology of much of Scholasticism. "The critique of onto-theology belongs to a tradition of dehellenizing repristination," Westphal writes.¹⁷ Yes—and this is precisely what puts it into open conflict with Scholasticism.

What is the philosophical significance of the biographical root of *Sein und Zeit* for our question? The use of biography in philosophy tends to come under attack from students of Heidegger impressed by his *Sache*-driven methodology. Are biography and chronology not accidental to philosophy? Can we not say of Heidegger's life what Heidegger once said of Aristotle's—he lived, he worked, he died—and then move on to the issues at hand? I have not dealt with the *Sache*, it will be objected. Instead of thinking *what* Heidegger has said, I have busied myself with *why* Heidegger said it. This is biography, not philosophy. This is a serious

15. Ibid., 7.

16. Ibid.

17. Ibid., 18.

consideration. My answer: the *Sache* at issue here, Heidegger's objection to Scholastic ontology, essentially involves Heidegger's biography. Biographical contextualization, always to some degree helpful, is crucial to understanding Heidegger, with his concealed agendas and complex theological motivations. Without it, we cannot understand how Heidegger moved from being a self-appointed defender of "the spiritual potential of Scholasticism"¹⁸ to being an advocate of formally atheistic hermeneutics in the space of six years. Nor can we fully understand how *Sein und Zeit* constitutes an alternative to Scholastic ontology.

Educated in the Scholastic way of thinking (particularly Franciscan Scholasticism),¹⁹ Heidegger wrote his *Habilitationsschrift* on the problem of the categories in John Duns Scotus and moved more or less comfortably within neo-Scholastic circles.²⁰ In 1916, he saw himself as a Scholastic phenomenologist of some kind and anticipated making a major contribution to a renaissance of philosophical interest in the Middle Ages. Heidegger always admitted the importance of this medieval-theological provenance for his development, however tersely: "Without this theological start, I would never have come onto the path of thought. But our origins always lie before us (*Herkunft aber bleibt stets Zukunft*)" (GA12 96/10). As a newly minted *Privatdozent*, Heidegger argued that Scholasticism was ignored by contemporary thinkers at their own expense. The

18. Martin Heidegger, from his 1915 application for a grant from the Schaezler Foundation in honor of St. Thomas Aquinas. See Ott, *Biographie*, 75/74.

19. Martin Heidegger, "Mein Weg in die Phänomenologie," *Zur Sache des Denkens* (Tübingen: Niemeyer, 1969), 82; English: "My Way in Phenomenology," in *On Time and Being*, trans. Joan Stambaugh (New York: Harper & Row, 1972), 75.

20. Martin Heidegger, *Die Kategorien- und Bedeutungslehre des Duns Scotus*, GA1 189–401; English: *Duns Scotus' Theory of the Categories and of Meaning*, trans. Harold Robbins (Ph.D. diss., De Paul University, 1978). On Heidegger's study of Scotus, see Sean J. McGrath, "Die scotistische Phänomenologie des jungen Heidegger," in Denker, Gander, and Zaborowski, *Heidegger-Jahrbuch*, 1:243–58; idem, "Heidegger and Duns Scotus on Truth and Language," *Review of Metaphysics* 57 (2003): 323–43; W. Kölmel, *Heidegger und Duns Scoti*, in *Via Scoti: Methodologica ad mentem Joannis Duns Scoti*, ed. L. Sileo (Rome: Antonianum, 1995), vol. 2, 1145–55; M. Rampley, "Meaning and Language in Early Heidegger: From Duns Scotus to 'Being and Time,'" *Journal of the British Society for Phenomenology* 25 (1994): 209–28; Kisiel, *Genesis of Being and Time*, 21–68; Olivier Boulnois, *Entre logique et sémantique. Heidegger lecteur de Duns Scot*, in *Phénoménologique et logique*, ed. Jean-François Courtine (Paris: Presses de l'Ecole Normale Supérieure, 1996), 261–81; and John D. Caputo, "Phenomenology, Mysticism and the 'Grammatica Speculativa': A Study of Heidegger's Habilitationsschrift," *Journal of the British Society for Phenomenology* 5 (1974): 101–17.

cloister-bound history of *meditatio* and *disputatae* on the relationship between the Jewish-Christian scriptures and Greco-Roman *scientia* was the incubator of the Western genius.

Heidegger's approach to Scholasticism in the *Habilitationsschrift* stands in marked contrast to the polemical reading of Augustine in the 1921 lectures, "Augustinus und der Neuplatonismus" (GA60 157–299), or the 1927 reading of *essentia* and *existentia* (GA24 109–71/77–121), and its sequel in the 1941 Nietzsche lectures (GA6.2 363–416). During the years 1917 to 1919, Heidegger came to believe that the Scholastic assumption that we can understand *something* of the true God through a rational reflection on creation was an illusion. Not only was it deceptive of our theological predicament, it was also distortive of our philosophical situation. Philosophy must articulate the world as it is, not as it might appear to faith. In his notes and lectures from these years, Heidegger expressed an increasing suspicion that Scholastic philosophical theism obfuscates, if not precludes, the hermeneutics of facticity.

This "path of thinking" would lead Heidegger out of the Catholic Church into neo-orthodox Protestantism and finally to an a-theological stance that severed all philosophical ties to theism. Following Wilhelm Dilthey, the young Heidegger came to understand the life-consciousness of primal Christianity, the God-intensified "self-world" of Christian discipleship, which comes to acute expression in Augustine, as the birth of historical consciousness in the Western tradition. This pristine moment was betrayed by the Scholastic fusion of theology and ancient science. In the Reformation, particularly in the figure of the young Luther, the repressed self-world of primal Christianity rose up in rebellion, tearing down the suffocating constructs of Scholastic science and retrieving historically saturated, authentic Christian faith. Luther's *theologia crucis* became Heidegger's paradigm for separating theology, an ontic science of a putative historical revelation, from philosophy, the factual ontology of temporal life.²¹ Heidegger took from Luther's *theologia crucis* an understanding of why philosophy must be "in principle atheistic" (PIA 246/121). He turned what Luther regarded as the theological limitations of philoso-

21. Van Buren, in his "Martin Heidegger. Martin Luther," and Greisch, in *L'Arbre de vie et l'arbre du savoir*, maintain similar positions.

phy into a strength: bereft of a natural consciousness of God, philosophy was in a privileged position to let the factic speak on its own terms. The 1921 Augustine lectures, the method and presuppositions of *Sein und Zeit*, the 1927 *Destruktion* of medieval ontology, and the later interpretations of onto-theology are fore-grounded in the prejudgment that the “object” of ontology is the temporal, finite, and Godforsaken being which we ourselves are. Interpreted by this presupposition, Scholasticism’s role in the history of being becomes the inglorious one of precipitating the definitive forgetting of the ontological difference in the modern age. Scholasticism, like every philosophical theism, was not able to think the being of beings. The causal reduction of beings to an a-temporal principle, the first cause, the *actus purus*, eclipsed temporality. Not only was it a program for making historical life easier, a systematic flight from finitude, it created the conditions necessary for the modern hegemony of theory. When the paradigm for the real is God’s judgment that grants existence to essences, the paradigm for truth becomes the *adaequatio* of judgment with things. Primordial truth, unconcealment (*aletheia*), is forgotten, and the theoretical comportment is enshrined as the only way to access being.

In 1919, Heidegger expressed his interior (if not formal) break with “the system of Catholicism” to his priest friend Engelbert Krebs.²² Although we have little textual record of Heidegger’s study of Luther, which doubtless precipitated this break, he left traces of his interest in Luther in occasional remarks scattered throughout the early Freiburg and Marburg lectures. From these references, we can reconstruct Heidegger’s early philosophy as a search for a hermeneutical phenomenological complement to Luther’s *theologia crucis*. Already in the ’50s, the Luther scholar Edmund Schlink described Heidegger’s philosophy as “a radical secularization of Luther’s anthropology.”²³ Luther’s objection to Scholasticism as the *theologia gloriae*, an intrusion of Greek metaphysics into Christianity, and a substitution of a philosophical principle for the crucified God, awakened Heidegger. In tandem with Luther’s *theologia crucis*, Heidegger’s hermeneutics of facticity exposes the derivative nature of Scho-

22. Martin Heidegger, letter to Engelbert Krebs, January 9, 1919, cited in full in Ott, *Biographie*, 106–7/106.

23. Edmund Schlink, “Weisheit und Torheit,” *Kerygma und Dogma* 1 (1955): 6.

lastic philosophical theology and intensifies the uncertainty, difficulty, and Godforsakenness of human existence. Jean Greisch writes: "Without directly saying it, he [Heidegger] suggests that the hermeneutics of facticity can make a pact with the Theology of the Cross."²⁴

The subtitle of this book, *Phenomenology for the Godforsaken*, requires some explanation. Strictly speaking, Godforsakenness is distinct from Godlessness. Only a believer can be Godforsaken. Jesus' cry from the Cross, "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" (Mk 15:33), is often misinterpreted as an expression of the Son's loss of faith at the moment of maximal suffering. Jesus is in fact quoting a psalm (Ps 22). While the cry expresses the distance from the Father suffered by the Son in effecting Redemption—the Son's participation in the experience of sin—this is still no "atheistic howl." Rather, it is the anguished cry of a believer who feels abandoned by God. It is the tormented faith of Job. Jesus does not cease to believe in the existence of God in his moment of Godforsakenness; on the contrary, the cry is an affirmation of the existence of God—in spite of everything. The cry is far from Godless; rather, it is the most extreme articulation of faith, a confession of belief when nothing confirms it. The Godless, on the other hand, has no God by whom he could be Godforsaken. He worships nothing and so does not complain either. When he suffers, he does not shout his indignation to the heavens. The Godless does not experience the *absence* of God, the *non-presence* of God; rather, he does not experience God at all.

What, then, does it mean to call *Sein und Zeit* a phenomenology for the Godforsaken? It means, first of all, that the *Daseinanalytic* is no neutral description of facticity, an experience of "average everydayness" which is available to all in the same way. It is a description of a historically and situationally determined existence, the experience of facticity that is the privilege and the curse of a certain kind of Christian faith. For only a Christian could describe facticity as Godforsaken. They would mean by this that human life is so disfigured by sin (the *aversio Dei*) as to be factically an experience of what ought not to be—createdness without an experience of the Creator, finitude without infinity. To claim, as I have, that Heidegger has deliberately overturned the neutrality central to Husserl's

24. Greisch, *L'Arbre de vie et l'arbre du savoir*, 247.

effort and written a phenomenology for the Godforsaken is to claim: (1) that Heidegger has situated himself within a certain form of Christian faith; (2) that what he describes in *Sein und Zeit* is only describable as it has been described from that faith-perspective; (3) that the question of Dasein's relation to God has not been left open; on the contrary, it has been decided in advance.

This is different from the tired accusation of secularization. *Sein und Zeit* is not a secularization of Luther but a hermeneutical complement to Luther, in a sense, a Lutheran phenomenology of Dasein. The Godless would perhaps find here much that illuminates their own experience. They may even be driven to seek further clues into the meaning of facticity in something like a radical theology of revelation, that is, a theology that denies a natural consciousness or experience of God. In this way, the early Heidegger understands himself to be serving the Lutheran cause, intensifying the Godforsakenness of life and thus preserving the integrity of a theology of revelation. This is the key to the dense 1921 claim that the formally atheistic hermeneutics of facticity is both a turn away from God and a remaining with God. "Philosophy is a departure from God, and, in its radical enactment of its 'way,' a singularly difficult remaining-near God" (GA61 197).²⁵ In the *Natorp Bericht*, Heidegger explains that philosophy must in some way turn away from God ("raise its hand against God") if it is to remain itself. Only thus can it realize an authentic relationship to God: "This throwing of life back upon itself which gets actualized in philosophy is something that in religious terms amounts to raising one's hand against God. But philosophy is thereby only being honest with itself and standing firm on this, that is, it is comporting itself in such a manner that is fitting to the only possibility of standing before God that is available to it as such" (PIA 246/193–94 n. 9). Heidegger has made a decision about what possible relation to God is available to philosophy. He has not denied the existence of God. Rather, he has denied philosophy the possibility of affirming this existence.

25. GA61 197: "Philosophie muss in ihrer radikalen, sich auf sich selbst stellenden Fraglichkeit prinzipiell a-theistisch sein. Sie darf sich gerade ob ihrer Grundtendenz nicht vermessen, Gott zu haben und zu bestimmen. Je radikaler sie ist, umso bestimmter ist sie ein weg von ihm, also gerade im radikalen Vollzug des 'weg' ein eigenes schwieriges 'bei' ihm."

There is, then, a fourth implication to the claim that *Sein und Zeit* is a phenomenology for the Godforsaken: (4) The human being is interpreted as having no phenomenological experience of God. Here Heidegger ventures a claim that is in principle phenomenologically falsifiable. The “disproof” would involve an elaboration of a factual experience of God “natural” to Dasein, that is, a religiosity independent of a biblical revelation. I have argued that phenomenology must take the possibility of such experience into account and endeavor to thematize it, however difficult that may be. But is this not simply a phenomenology that is theologically motivated in an alternative way? Is this not simply a Roman Catholic version of a *Daseinanalytic*? For the moment, I am committed to this: one need not be Roman Catholic to recognize Dasein’s concern for what we call God. In the metaphysical tradition, the arguments for God’s existence serve to bridge a theology of revelation and a philosophically independent investigation of nature. I wish to remain, at least in this discussion, within the phenomenological brackets. Even in suspension of metaphysics, being-before-God shows itself in human living. On these grounds, I believe that the *Daseinanalytic* fails to stay with the basic terms of factual life.

The context of the young Heidegger’s turn to Luther was the reactionary neo-Scholasticism of early-twentieth-century Catholic theology. Leo XIII’s 1870 encyclical *Aeterni Patris* declared Thomas Aquinas the philosopher for the Catholic Church. Pius X’s 1907 encyclical *Pascendi* foreclosed as “modernism” most efforts to integrate the insights of modern philosophy, science, and historiography into Catholic theology. The 1914 encyclical *Motu Proprio* declared Aquinas necessary for priestly formation in the Church. It seemed to the young Heidegger that the Catholic hierarchy was dictating in advance what must be true and false for philosophy. Between the years 1909 and 1911, Heidegger came under the influence of Carl Braig, a theologian who sought to mediate medieval Scholasticism and German idealism. Braig was an outspoken critic of papally enforced neo-Scholasticism.²⁶ Some of Braig’s rebelliousness

26. Bernhard Welte, “150 Jahre Theologische Fakultät Freiburg als Exempelfall theologischer Entwicklung,” in *Zwischen Zeit und Ewigkeit. Abhandlungen und Versuche* (Freiburg im Breisgau: Herder, 1982), 135–57, at 150. Heidegger spoke of the importance of Braig for his development in

rubbed off on his student. In a 1914 letter to Krebs, Heidegger writes: “The *motu proprio* was all we needed. Perhaps you as an ‘academic’ could seek a better way, whereby those who have fallen away can correct their thinking by having their brains removed and replaced with ‘Italian salad.’ For our philosophical needs, we could line up at vending machines in the train station.”²⁷ The neo-Scholasticism inspired by the Counter-Reformation, the political revolutions of the nineteenth century, and the papal pronouncements of the early twentieth century was rigid, formulaic, and usually ignorant of modern philosophy. Kant was generally regarded with suspicion, and therefore not read. Aquinas, Bonaventure, and Scotus were systematized into an alternative to the great modern systems, a Scholastic system which was then fed to seminarians in manuals as the only true philosophy.²⁸ This textbook Scholasticism is the same monster against which both Bernard Lonergan and Karl Rahner railed. The young Heidegger was suspicious of it from the beginning of his academic career. In a critical review, published in *Der Akademiker* in 1912, of one of the standard theological textbooks, Joseph Gredt’s *Elementa Philosophiae Aristotelico-Thomisticae*, the student Heidegger argues that philosophy cannot be understood as “a settled summary of doctrinal theses,” but only as “a continuous struggle for the truth.” Scholastic logic should be “set free from its rigidity and supposed finality” (GA16 29).²⁹ The neo-Scholastics endeavored to develop a hermetically sealed philosophical system, which could serve as a secure foundation for the Church by excluding modern insights and questions, advancing itself as timeless truth, a *philosophia perennis*. Heidegger’s *Habilitationsschrift*, a historical and hermeneutical investigation of Duns Scotus in the light of contemporary develop-

“Mein Weg,” 81–82/74–75. On Braig, see Karl Leidlmair, “Carl Braig,” in *Christliche Philosophie im katholischen Denken des 19. und 20. Jahrhunderts*, vol. 1, *Neue Ansätze im 19. Jahrhundert*, ed. Emerich Coreth, Walter M. Neidl, and Georg Pfligersdorffer (Graz: Styria, 1987), 409–19. On Braig’s influence on Heidegger, see Caputo, *Heidegger and Aquinas*, 45–55; Schaeffler, *Frömmigkeit des Denkens*, 1–10.

27. Martin Heidegger, letter to Engelbert Krebs, July 19th, 1914, in Denker, Gander, and Zaborowski, *Heidegger-Jahrbuch*, 1:61–62.

28. Bernhard Casper, “Das theologisch-scholastische Umfeld,” in Esposito and Porro, *Quaestio* 1:11–22, at 21.

29. Joseph Gredt, *Elementa Philosophiae Aristotelico-Thomisticae* (Rome, 1899–1901). Heidegger’s review is published in GA16 29–30.

ments in phenomenology and neo-Kantianism, was an act of defiance.³⁰

Heidegger's difficulties with neo-Scholasticism would quickly deepen into an objection to medieval philosophy itself. In his early lectures on phenomenology, Heidegger argues that the deduction of a first cause of being neuters ontology, de-temporalizes it, and makes a phenomenological investigation of historical life on its own terms impossible. When philosophy presumes access to an *ens infinitum*, the answer to the question of the meaning of being is given in advance: being means God; all other beings *are* insofar as they participate in the *actus purus*. Factual life is interpreted in terms of non-factual eternity. Temporality is excluded from the discussion, and theology is substituted for the understanding native to life. Against this trajectory, Heidegger maintains that philosophy is "the explicit and genuine actualization of the tendency towards interpretation that belongs to the basic movements of life in which what is at issue is this life itself and its being" (PIA 246/121). The phenomenological maxim, "back to the things themselves" is a call to hold thinking to life. Philosophy must resist the perennial temptation to take a balloon ride into the absolute; it must remain true to its theme, "conceptually grasping factual life in terms of the decisive possibilities of its being." Philosophy becomes, then, an existential act of bringing life to an authentic encounter with its own finitude. Heidegger enjoins philosophy "to throw factual life back on itself as this is possible in this factual life itself and to let it fend for itself in terms of its own factual possibilities" (PIA 246/121). Heidegger's notion of being as temporal horizon projected by Dasein, or later, as *Ereignis*, the occurrence of being, which sends Dasein into a particular dispensation of *Seinsverständnis*, is intended to break with every medieval ontology. Scholasticism defines potency in terms of act and identifies being with the *actus purus*, the infinite, divine act of existence. Heidegger elevates potency above act and identifies being with time. Medieval philosophy is *Seinsvergessenheit* to "the second power."³¹ It compounds the distortion already at work in Plato, the identification of being with constant presence, with the causal derivation of all beings from the *actus purus*. As Thomas Sheehan puts it, "medieval philosophy articulat-

30. Casper, "Das theologisch-scholastische Umfeld," 21.

31. Sheehan, "Notes on a 'Lovers' Quarrel," 137.

ed being not as essentially temporal and finite but as eternally stable reality rooted in the actuality of the Supreme Act, and in so doing, delivered to modern philosophy all that it would need to transform being into the horizon of objectifiability posited by the transcendental subject.”³² The later Heidegger’s etymological analyses derive the primordial Greek pre-ousiological notion of being, *physis*, from *phainesthai*, “to appear.” Unlike *ousia*, *physis* denotes withdrawal and hiddenness as much as emergence and presence. This dynamic of “presencing,” emerging from absence, can still be seen in Aristotle’s notion of *energeia*. With the Scholastic translation of *energeia* into *actualitas*, that which is effected by a working activity, the temporal association in *physis* is forgotten. In the later Heidegger’s view, this development was not a failure on the part of Scholasticism, but the fate of Western thinking. Heidegger writes in *Der Satz vom Grund*: “It would be foolish to say that the medieval theologians misunderstood Aristotle; rather, they understood him differently, corresponding to the different way in which being sent itself to them” (GA10 117–18/79).

Heidegger excludes from the outset of *Sein und Zeit* the possibility of a knowledge or experience of a nontemporal, immutable, and infinite being. *Sein und Zeit* is an ontology of the human being without reference to the possibility of God. To be sure, Heidegger acknowledges “being-toward-God” (*das Sein des Menschen zu Gott*); it is summarily dismissed as a special mode of being-in-the-world, something for theology to work out (SZ 8/10). Thinking has no recourse to nontemporal being. “If being is to be conceived in terms of time and if the various modes and derivatives of being, in their modifications and derivations, are in fact to become intelligible through considerations of time, then being itself—and not only beings that are ‘in time’—is made visible in its ‘temporal’ character. But then ‘temporal’ can no longer mean only ‘being in time.’ The ‘a-temporal’ and the ‘supratemporal’ are also ‘temporal’ with respect to their being; this not only by way of privation when compared to ‘temporal’ beings which are ‘in time’. . . . Being is in each instance comprehensible only in regard to time”(SZ 18–19/16). It is crucial to see that the above passage hinges on a conditional: “*If being is to be conceived in terms of time. . .*” Why *should* being be conceived in terms of time? Heidegger

32. Ibid., 138.

is not recommending the substitution of one dogmatism for another. He believes that the assumption of the temporality of being, the reversal of the Scholastic thesis, to some degree decrypts the meaning of being. The assumption effects a reversal of the metaphysical tradition on multiple levels. The Scholastic thesis, the assumption of a first cause of being, forgets the ontological difference. Heidegger's antithesis accents the difference. The Scholastic thesis holds that changing beings participate in that which does not change and are real to that degree. Heidegger's antithesis holds that beings *are* to the degree that they are temporalized. The Scholastic thesis privileges act over potency, Heidegger's antithesis means that "higher than actuality stands possibility" (SZ 38/34). The Scholastic thesis makes God the starting point for philosophy. Heidegger's antithesis excludes God from ontology, for if being means time, God cannot be said to be.

With a philosophy of God removed from the scope of possibilities for thinking, the Scholastic bridge between a rational philosophy and a revealed theology is annihilated. Philosophy is freed from its tutelage to theology, and Christian theology is purified of Hellenistic philosophical infestation. Just as philosophy does not and cannot believe, theology, in Heidegger's view, does not philosophize. As "a thinking and questioning elaboration of the world of Christian experience, i.e., of faith" (GA40 9/8 August 16, 2005), theology's work has little or nothing to do with philosophy. "If I were to write a theology," Heidegger said in Zurich in 1951, "then the word *being* would not occur in it. Faith does not need the thought of being. When faith has recourse to this thought, it is no longer faith. This is what Luther understood" (GA15 436–37). Philosophy does not believe because it has no reason to believe. It is not *given* a God to think. The being of beings is not divine. It is not a cause, not an absolute, but an event, not something that subsists, but something that comes to pass, a process, the completion of which in some sense depends upon Dasein.

The early Heidegger's atheological position seems to be abrogated in his later writings. The celebrated theological neutrality of the *Humanismusbrief* and the *Beiträge's* doctrine of "the last god" are apparent departures from the earlier talk of the necessary atheism of philosophy. By remaining silent about God, *Sein und Zeit* serves "the holy," we are told in

the *Humanismusbrief*. It demolishes idols in order to clear a space for the truly divine God. *Sein und Zeit* is ostensibly a postmodern *via negativa* (GA9 350 ff./266 ff.). In the *Beiträge*, this *via negativa* becomes an explicit severing of ontology from divinity. Having destroyed onto-theology, Heidegger has cleared the space for the advent of the last god.³³ Should the unknown divinity reveal itself, it would not be the god of the philosophers, the *causa sui*, to whom “man can neither pray, nor sacrifice,” before whom “he can neither fall to his knees in awe nor can he play music and dance” (ID 70/72). It is worth noting that many scholars see in these passages from the *Humanismusbrief* possibilities for a more positive relationship between Heideggerian thought and philosophical theology than the one I have presented in this book. Heidegger’s *Wirkungsgeschichte* on philosophical theology may be loosely grouped under four headings: transcendental, metaphysical, deconstructive, and phenomenological. The post-Heideggerian transcendentalists seek a non-ontic foundation for theism in a transcendental analysis of subjectivity. The condition of the possibility of all our intellectual and volitional acts is held to be a pre-thematic experience of infinite being.³⁴ The post-Heideggerian metaphysicians, distancing themselves from the inchoate idealism of the former, retrieve from Aquinas a distinction between the being of being and the being of God, which allows for a temporalization of our finite understanding of being, without detracting from the infinity of God.³⁵ The de-

33. GA65 409–17/288–93.

34. See Karl Rahner, *Foundations of Christian Faith*, trans. William Dych (New York: Crossroads, 1978); Emerich Coreth, *Metaphysics*, trans. Joseph Donceel (New York: Herder and Herder, 1968). On the relationship of Rahner’s theology to Heidegger’s ontology, see Thomas Sheehan, *Karl Rahner: The Philosophical Foundations* (Athens: Ohio University Press, 1987).

35. See Gustav Siewerth, *Gesammelte Werke*, vols. 1–4, ed. Wolfgang Behler and Alma von Stockhausen (Düsseldorf: Patmos, 1971–87), especially “Das Sein als Gleichnis Gottes,” in vol. 1. A translation of this seminal Siewerthian text is in preparation by Andrzej Wiercinski. On Siewerth, see Emmanuel Tourpe, *Siewerth ‘après’ Siewerth. Le lien idéal de l’amour dans le Thomisme spéculatif de Gustav Siewerth et la visée d’un réalisme transcendantal*, Bibliothèque Philosophique de Louvain, vol. 49 (Louvain: Peeters, 1998); Andrzej Wiercinski, *Inspired Metaphysics? Gustav Siewerth’s Hermeneutic Reading of the Onto-theological Tradition* (Toronto: Hermeneutic Press, 2003); idem, *Die scholastischen Vorbedingungen der Metaphysik Gustav Siewerths* (Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang, 1991); idem, *Über die Differenz im Sein. Metaphysische Überlegungen zu Gustav Siewerths Werk* (Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang, 1989). See also the work of Ferdinand Ulrich, especially *Homo Abyssus. Das Wagnis der Seinsfrage (Sammlung Horizonte)* (Freiburg im Breisgau: Johannes Verlag, 1961, 2nd ed., 1998). See also Martin Bieler, “The Future of the Philosophy of Being,” *Communio* 26 (1999): 455–85.

constructionist theologians (if they can still be called theologians) draw on Jacques Derrida to gesture rhetorically to a non-logocentric, non-ontological *via negativa*.³⁶ The post-Heideggerian phenomenologists of religion, deeply impressed by Emmanuel Levinas's ethical critique of Heidegger, advance a Husserlian phenomenological exploration of God, not as being, but as the possibility of absolute givenness.³⁷ An earlier school of post-Heideggerian phenomenology, founded by Bernhard Welte, interpreted Heidegger as an iconoclast, who liberates authentic theism from the conceptual idolatry of the onto-theological tradition.³⁸ Each of these deserves an extensive treatment of its own. Together, they are outlined here as markers of a field that is growing daily.

In a recent piece, the German philosopher of religion, Bernhard Casper, outlines an interpretation of Heidegger's relationship to Scholasticism informed by the basic positions of the Welte school.³⁹ Since it stands in tension with the interpretation advanced in this book, it deserves some attention here. Casper builds his argument on the undeniable fact that Heidegger's critique of onto-theology is rooted in his early theological objections to the formulaic rigidity of neo-Scholasticism. Casper argues that Heidegger's critique is not in itself opposed to phil-

36. See Harold Coward and Toby Foshay, eds., *Derrida and Negative Theology* (Albany: State University of New York Press, 1992); Gianni Vattimo, *After Christianity*, trans. Luca D'Isanto (New York: Columbia University Press, 2002); idem, *Belief* (Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 2000); John D. Caputo, *The Prayers and Tears of Jacques Derrida* (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1997).

37. See Jean Luc Marion, *Being Given: Toward a Phenomenology of Givenness*, trans. Jeffrey L. Kosky (Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 2002); idem, *God Without Being*. See also Emmanuel Levinas, *God, Death and Time*, trans. Bettina Bergo (Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 2000); idem, *Of God Who Comes to Mind*, trans. Bettina Bergo (Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 1998). Although his work maintains strict boundaries between philosophical and theological questions, Paul Ricoeur belongs to this post-Heideggerian phenomenological theology movement. See his *Figuring the Sacred: Religion, Narrative, and Imagination*, trans. David Pellauer, ed. Mark I. Wallace (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1995), 48–67. Richard Kearney has done much to develop the theological potential of Ricoeur's hermeneutics. See his *The God Who May Be: A Hermeneutics of Religion* (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 2001).

38. Welte, *Zwischen Zeit und Ewigkeit*; idem, *Religionsphilosophie* (Freiburg im Breisgau: Herder, 1978); Klaus Hemmerle, *Auf den göttlichen Gott zudenken* (Freiburg im Breisgau: Herder, 1996); Bernhard Casper, Klaus Hemmerle, and Peter Hünnerman, eds., *Besinnung auf das Heilige* (Freiburg im Breisgau: Herder, 1966). Although he seems to be unaware of the Welte school, Laurence P. Hemming's positions place him in a certain proximity to it. See his *Heidegger's Atheism: The Refusal of a Theological Voice* (Notre Dame: Indiana University Press, 2003).

39. Casper, "Das theologisch-scholastische Umfeld."

osophical theology but only to a certain variety of it, “the ecclesiastical neo-Scholasticism” which understands itself as “a closed system and a timeless and a-historical ground of all knowledge.”⁴⁰ In Casper’s view, Heidegger’s 1919 “break with Catholicism” has more to do with the rejection of neo-Scholastic formulas than it does with Lutheranism. Casper sees a unity in Heidegger’s path, from his student writings to the later work. Heidegger’s lifework is a one-pointed search for “the ground,” the foundation of thinking and being. Casper notes that already in the early student book reviews, Heidegger is articulating a notion of thinking as a will to the ground (*der Wille zum Grund*), a directedness that “signifies [also] the desire for a knowledge of God.”⁴¹ The target of Heidegger’s critique of onto-theology is, therefore, not Catholic theology as such, but any mitigation or foreclosure of questioning with a premature answer. Systematized neo-Scholasticism is not genuine theism. It is what Heidegger will call in 1928 the “ontic belief in God,” which is basically “godless” (GA26 211 n. 3/165). Insofar as it closes down honest questioning with prescribed Church-approved answers, it is in fact idolatrous. Casper writes, “Every failure in the pursuit of this search must then be understood as a fall from the true relationship to God, as the worship of other gods.”⁴² The philosophy of the “*causa sui*,” which Heidegger denounces as idolatry in *Identity and Difference*, is the textbook Scholastic theology, not the works of Aquinas or Scotus.⁴³ Hence Heidegger does not preclude but supports an authentic philosophical search for God and a genuine philosophical theism.

The present work argues otherwise. Heidegger’s departure from the Catholic tradition, although precipitated by the modernist crisis, is shown to harden over time into a substantive divergence. Heidegger annuls the central Thomistic hermeneutical principle of the analogical unity of the being of God and the being of creation, the *analogia entis*. Scotus notwithstanding, this Thomistic principle grounds not only the sacramental life of the Church, but also the possibility of a philosophical knowledge of God. The interpretation of “being” as “time” is intended to make the *analogia entis* impossible. The assumption of time as the hori-

40. Ibid., 21.

42. Ibid.

41. Ibid., 13.

43. Ibid., 17.

zon of being is complexly related to Heidegger's appropriation of Luther. As such, it has a theological underside. It is not only a hermeneutical-phenomenological principle, it is also a declaration of what is and what is not theologically possible for the human being. The assumption of ontological Godlessness invites a radical theology of revelation to declare its No to philosophy. However—and this is my claim against Heidegger—it lacks full phenomenological confirmation in experience. Far from being Godless, the human being seems to be spontaneously religious. This ontological directedness toward the infinite must be distinguished from *religio*, the virtue of honoring and worshiping God. The former is an existential and thus an inalienable possession of every human being; the latter is a virtue practiced by some but not by others. But the virtue of *religio* would not be possible without ontological religiousness.⁴⁴ The central argument of this book is a hermeneutical objection to Heidegger's presupposition of formal atheism, on the ground that it conceals more than it reveals. The assumption of factual Godforsakenness is shown to be problematic insofar as it leaves an essential dimension of being-in-the-world in darkness.

The later Heidegger is on the track of something decisively non-Christian, a pre-Judaic experience of "the holy" free of theistic associations and interpretations. He has set up the conditions for the possibility of such a post-Christian religiosity by ransacking Jewish-Christian texts, formalizing their most characteristic features and declaring them the rightful property of philosophy. He frequently dismisses the very Christian sources upon which he himself so heavily relies. If occasionally the Christians hit upon something true, as for example, in the case of Augustine or Kierkegaard, they generally lack the power to follow the truth into its concealed ground. Jacques Derrida has remarked on the peculiar inauthenticity of Heidegger's treatment of his Christian sources. In *The Gift of Death*, he writes: "Heideggerian thought was not simply a constant

44. Markus Enders has called for the careful distinction of the ontological ground of religiosity from the practice of religion as such. See his "Ist der Mensch von Natur aus religiös? Zur Aktualität und Wiederkehr der Religion," in *Bildung. Identität. Religion. Fragen zum Wesen des Menschen*, ed. Hans Poser and Bruno B. Reuer (Berlin: Weidler Buchverlag, 2004), 221–39; "Ist 'Religion' wirklich undefinierbar? Überlegungen zu einem interreligiös verwendbaren Religionsbegriff," in Enders and Zaborowski, *Phänomenologie der Religion*, 49–87.

attempt to separate itself from Christianity. . . . The same Heideggerian thinking often consists, notably in *Sein und Zeit*, in repeating on an ontological level Christian themes and texts that have been 'de-Christianized.' Such themes and texts are then presented as ontic, anthropological, or contrived attempts that come to a sudden halt on the way to an ontological recovery of their own originary possibility."⁴⁵

What are we to make of Heidegger's hermeneutical violence to the Christian tradition? What is Heidegger saying about the Christianity that he treats so badly? Can his position be made more explicit than he articulated, with his cryptic remarks about theological origins, and his gravid silence on religious matters? Can we find clues in a careful reconstruction of his research into medieval and early Christian texts? If we find that something is hermeneutically astray here, that in some way, the subject matter itself has been violated, does the exposure of a weakness in Heidegger's philosophy strengthen that which he sought to overturn? Could this rehabilitate medieval theism in some way? This is, admittedly, a circuitous way of showing the relevance of medieval philosophy. But perhaps, this indirect approach is exactly what is needed. There is no shortage of medieval enthusiasts who dream of a return to the thirteenth century. Scholasticism needs to be presented from a fresh perspective, in a more contemporary light, which could reveal its unexplored resources for addressing "postmodern" philosophical problems.

This book is about Heidegger's relationship with Scholasticism, it is not a retrieval of Scholasticism as such. Nonetheless, my reading of Heidegger is determined by a certain understanding of the subject matter. My approach to Scholasticism is fore-grounded in an appropriation of the following four, broadly "Thomistic," claims:

1. The distinction between the being of beings and the being of God is the true interpretation of the *analogia entis*. That we must affirm both a continuity and a discontinuity between the being of beings and the being of God precludes all one-sidedness in philosophical theology. Lutheran one-sidedness, with its modern representatives, Heidegger, Barth, perhaps even Derrida, exaggerates the discontinuity between the human

45. Jacques Derrida, *The Gift of Death*, trans. David Wills (Chicago and London: University of Chicago Press, 1995), 22–23.

and the divine and so compromises the integrity of the human being, who remains an *imago Dei*, even in his fallenness. The Scotist notion of *univocatio entis* encourages a one-sided exaggeration of the continuity between the human and divine. It finds many modern supporters, for example, Hegel, who so overemphasizes the human being as *capax Dei* as to compromise the transcendence of God.

2. The *analogia entis* makes possible a nonreductionistic philosophical theology, not a philosophy of “either/or” but of “both/and.” It calls us to a delicate balance of tensions, a paradoxical affirmation/denial, a *via positiva* and a *via negativa*, a *theologia gloriae* and a *theologia crucis*, a God who is wholly with us and wholly other. This is not a Hegelian “both/and” but a Thomistic “both/and.” The synthesis is not a possession of the human spirit, but a mystery hidden in God.

3. The Scholastic notion of a *desiderium naturale*, the human desire for the fullness of being, can be interpreted as the ground of human religiosity. We are not only redirected to God by grace, we are directed to God ontologically. Hence we need both a phenomenology of religiousness and a theology of revelation. The former would include a descriptive analytic of all forms of religiosity, not only the ways-of-being-in-the-world of the great religions, but also the faith of everyday life. This would elaborate the monotheism of human finality, showing how all human desires, although they emerge out of the polytheism of the human “unconscious,” converge on a single transcendent point.

4. Ontological religiousness, the ground of human religiosity, is to be interpreted both eschatologically and mystically. It is both messianic and mystical. The being which we ourselves are is a being-before-God. The “before” has both a temporal and a spatial meaning: we await God and thus suffer the incompleteness that attends such awaiting, and, in rare moments of illumination, we experience the divine presence and awaken to our true position, before the Face.

My conclusion is a plea for a reappraisal of the factual ground of Scholastic philosophical theology. Factual religious experience is operative in Scholasticism. This leads to the question of the significance of factual religious experience in contemporary philosophy. Should this be only negatively and agnostically “formally indicated”? Or is something essentially

human here, which was at the center of Scholastic investigations, calling for a more careful phenomenological exposition?

A methodological note: while this work primarily concerns the early Heidegger (the lectures and writings up to and including *Sein und Zeit*), I draw on the later writings when a parallel or echo of a point can be found. That this violates the traditional divide between Heidegger I and II does not disturb me, on the contrary. If I have raised questions about the legitimacy of this distinction, I will have achieved even more than I set out to do.